adopt all means to obstruct the Government with the openly declared objective of seizing power. As you know, we have a multiplicity of political parties ranging from extreme right to extreme left – some are regional with no specific policy. Most of these have come together for the common purpose of paralyzing a constitutionally elected government. Even during our elections in 1971, their slogan was ‘Remove Indira Gandhi’. But they found that the people were not with them. Last year, with the economic difficulties due to the successive failures of rain and the world oil crisis, they thought that opportunity had come their way once again. They embarked on a policy of obstructing industrial production by fomenting strikes. They exhorted farmers not to sell produce to Government Agencies, the aim being to bring about the collapse of the distribution system in cities.’

14. BStU, MfS, AOP, Nr. 11806/85, Bd. 52, Bl. 125

15. Der Spiegel . 21 November 1976

16. On June 28, 1983

17. FBIS-EEU-77-055

18. Ibid

19. Neues Deutschland . 28 June 1980

20. Ibid

The Squeeze Begins

1. Letter from Norden to Honecker. 28 June 1977. Bundesarchive ZPA, IV B2/2028/20

2. FBIS-EEU-77-055